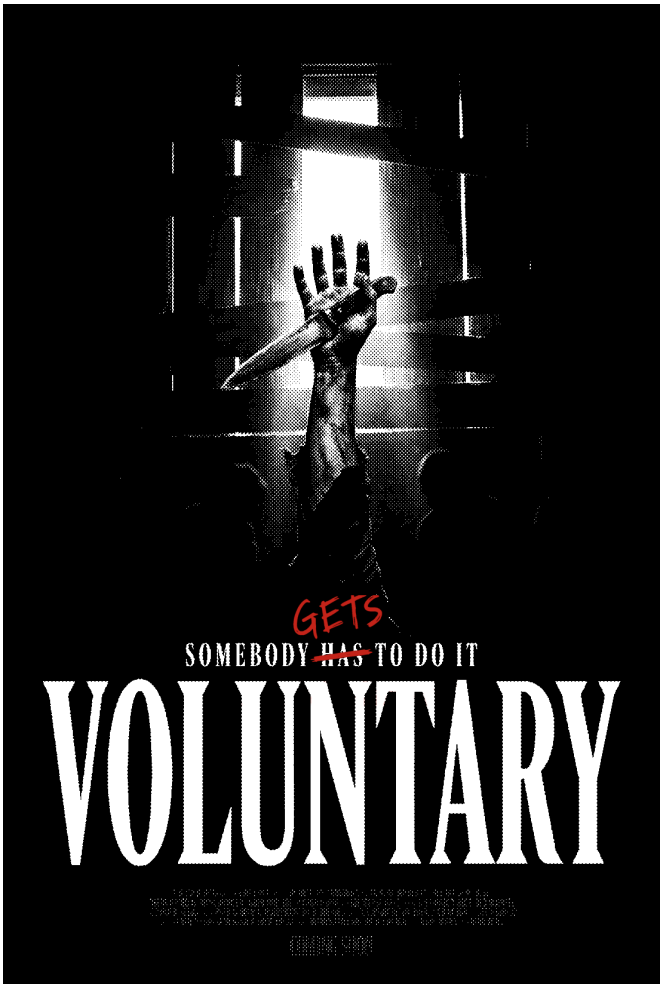


VOLUNTARY

Teaser trailer. Approx. 90 sec.

Teaser Trailer

Joshua Peters

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> THE RULE FOR THIS WHOLE PIECE: nothing in the trailer is funny until the last ten seconds. It is a somber prestige zombie drama about people forced to do an unthinkable thing. Every cut, every music choice, every card. The audience should be genuinely moved at 1:15. Then the stinger tells them what they were actually watching.
>
> Almost all of this is assembled from footage you already shot. Pickups are marked PU.

FADE IN:

BLACK. A production card, held. Silence.

NFA MEDIA

BLACK. Two seconds of nothing. Let it get uncomfortable.

A slow, single piano note.

INT. BOARDED-UP LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

EXTREME CLOSE. CRISTIAN's mouth. The gap where his teeth were. Breathing.

Hands tilt his chin toward the lantern.

No dialogue. Just the piano.

CUT TO:

NYLA wringing a rag into a bowl of water gone pink.

CUT TO:

CATHY in the doorway, not looking at the room. Listening to it.

NYLA (V.O.)
Nineteen.

CUT TO:

The boarded window. Amber light in the slats. Something moves past it, out of focus.

CUT TO:

INT. LIVING ROOM - LATER NOTE1

All five of them, dead silent, frozen mid-motion. Everyone looking up at the ceiling.

Nobody breathes.

Hold it. Hold it longer than is comfortable.

SMASH TO:

EXT. RESIDENTIAL STREET - NIGHT NOTE2

HANDHELD, low, fast, lurching. Someone running ahead of us in the dark. We are gaining.

A woman's back. Her legs. The road.

CUT TO BLACK.

A single low string note begins to build under everything from here.

INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

DEAN in the chair, rope across his chest, shaking.

DEAN
You have to kill me.

CUT TO:

NYLA, crying, shaking her head.

CUT TO:

DEAN
It's only a matter of time.

CUT TO:

CRISTIAN staring at the far wall. Not blinking.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - NIGHT NOTE3

A zombie standing perfectly still in the middle of the road, seen from far off, head down.

CUT TO:

INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT NOTE4

CATHY at the gap in the boards, looking out. Her face falls.

CATHY
(barely)
...Oh no.

The strings climb.

QUICK CUTS, accelerating, no dialogue:

Rope pulling tight across a chest.

The knife lifted off the table.

NYLA's hand over her mouth.

A boarded window shuddering as something hits it.

TERRY's face, lit from below, absolutely calm. The only calm face in the movie.

The lantern going over.

SILENCE. Cut the music dead.

INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

TERRY, quiet, to the room.

TERRY
Okay.

(beat)

I'll do it.

The four of them look at him. Nobody moves.

Hold on TERRY's face. He is the hero of this movie. The piano returns, one note.

SLOW FADE TO BLACK.

Beat.

MAIN TITLE, bone white on black, held in silence:

VOLUNTARY

Two full seconds. Let it sit. Let them think it's over.

Then, over black:

TERRY (V.O.)
No, you don't understand.

(beat)

I have to be the one who does it.

NYLA (V.O.)
Okay... thank you. But why?

A long pause.

TERRY (V.O.)
Because I actually hate him.

BEAT.

CATHY (V.O.)
Wait, WHAT?

HARD CUT TO BLACK. Music stops.

COMING SOON

Beat.

CRISTIAN (V.O.)
(deadpan, over black)
Can I have his teeth?

CUT TO BLACK. Out.

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> PICKUPS NEEDED (everything else is from the sketch and the bits)
>
> 1. Zombie POV handheld running down a residential street at night, low and lurching. 20 seconds of it. This is also the opening of the consent bit, so shoot it once and use it twice.
> 2. A zombie standing motionless in the middle of a road, wide, far off, head down. One shot.
> 3. A boarded window shuddering from an impact, from inside. One shot, easy, someone off camera hits it.
> 4. Lantern tipping over on the floor. One shot.

5. Clean audio pass of the V.O. lines against black, recorded quiet and close.

MUSIC. One piano note, one low string swell, one hard stop. Do not use a licensed horror trailer cue and do not use a BRAAAM. The restraint is what makes the stinger land. If the trailer sounds expensive and sad, the joke doubles.

WHY THE STINGER GOES AFTER THE TITLE. The whole trailer sells a noble sacrifice drama. The title card is the audience relaxing, thinking they know what this is. Everything funny is packed into the ten seconds after it. That is the structure that makes people send it to someone else.

THE TEETH LINE IS THE VERY LAST THING. After COMING SOON, over black, no picture. It costs one second and it is the button on the whole package.